

# Vincent Van Faux

## Your grievance with Grant

Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

## Your other secret

You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

## Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Ella knows you were behind the anonymous buybacks.
3. Persuade Claire that the student painting should not be displayed.

*When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.*

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

## **Hearing 1 / Motive**

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

### **READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER**

Grant planned to display an embarrassing student painting beside my latest work. It was not a retrospective. It was a hostage situation with a frame.

### **Your next action**

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

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## **Hearing 2 / Whereabouts**

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

### **ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer**

I was at the Registrar's copier from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with proxy paperwork for buying back my own early paintings. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

### **ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer**

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Registrar's copier. I was dealing with proxy paperwork for buying back my own early paintings. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

## **Hearing 3 / Evidence**

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

### **ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply**

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Registrar's copier throughout the whole window. It also exposes proxy paperwork for buying back my own early paintings. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

### **ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply**

I stand by my account of being at the Registrar's copier. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.